

# SHOOTING Stars

Digital cameras are no longer the domain of amateur or budding photographers—they're now mandatory additions to every household. Let's find out what models are out there, and which ones you should look to buy

Michael Browne

Capturing poignant memories, depicting significant events, and preserving them for future generations has been one of mankind's obsessions right from the time of the caveman. Etchings found in rock caverns are a mute testament to this. Nostalgia aside, we have things easy, don't we? Yes we do, courtesy the Digital Camera. There are a lot of options available, however, and the cavemen probably had it easier—they didn't have to do the choosing! But then, you've got us on your side!

We tested 24 digital cameras spanning all three price categories as mentioned in our *How We Tested* box: an entry-level category that consisted of an upper budget of Rs 8,500, a mid-range category with prices ranging from Rs 8,500 to Rs 14,999 and last, the Rs 15,000 and above category.

There are no strict parameters by which to judge the performance of a digital camera, excepting what you see. Megapixels and other factors being no bar, the ultimate test for any camera is the quality of the output. As a value-add to this test, we've decided to include the test shots of all the cameras on our DVD that will come with the next issue. Look out for it!

